



University center Abdelhafid Boussouf - Mila
2019-2020 Semestre 1
E-Learning unit

English - level 1

– Lesson 2 – Sentence Types

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Institut	Département	Année	Spécialité
-Lettres et Langues étrangères	- Français	-Français	Licence 1
-Sciences et Techniques	-MI- ST	-MI- ST	Licence 1
-Sciences Economique	-SE	-Toutes les spécialités	Licence 1

Objectives of this lesson:

- To signal the crucial importance of sentences
- To make you aware of the existence of more than one single type of sentences
- To make it easy for you to produce and identify sentences of different categories.

What is a sentence

A **sentence** is a grammatical unit containing usually two words or more. This unit should convey an independent complete meaning. So, it is only logical to argue that a sequence of two or more words than does not convey complete meaning cannot qualify for the status of a complete sentence. A sentence should contain a verb, which is viewed as the 'heart' of any English sentence. A sentence starts with a capital letter and ends with a full stop, a question mark or an exclamation mark.

It is crucial that you can easily produce and recognize four different types of sentences:

1. Simple sentence
2. Compound sentence
3. Complex sentence
4. Complex-compound sentence

1. Simple Sentences

A simple sentence contains a subject and a verb, and it may also have an object and modifiers. However, it contains only **one** independent clause.

Key: **Yellow, bold** = subject; green underline = verb, *blue, italics* = object, **pink, regular font** = prepositional phrase

Here are a few examples:

- **She** read.
- **She** completed *her literature review*.
- **He** organized *his sources* **by theme**.
- **They** studied *APA rules* **for many hours**.

2. Compound Sentences

A compound sentence contains at least **two** independent clauses. These two independent clauses can be combined with a comma and a coordinating conjunction or with a semicolon.

Key: independent clause = **yellow, bold**; comma or semicolon = **pink, regular font**; coordinating conjunction = green underline

Here are a few examples:

- **She completed her literature review**, **and she created her reference list**.
- **He organized his sources by theme**; **then, he updated his reference list**.
- **They studied APA rules for many hours**, **but they realized there was still much to learn**.

Using some compound sentences in writing allows for more sentence variety.

3. Complex Sentences

A complex sentence contains at least **one** independent clause and at least **one** dependent clause. Dependent clauses can refer to the subject (*who, which*) the sequence/time (*since, while*), or the causal elements (*because, if*) of the independent clause.

If a sentence begins with a dependent clause, note the comma after this clause. If, on the other hand, the sentence begins with an independent clause, there is not a comma separating the two clauses.

Key: independent clause = **yellow, bold**; comma = **pink, regular font**; dependent clause = *blue, italics*

Here are a few examples:

- *Although she completed her literature review*, **she still needed to work on her methods section**.
 - Note the comma in this sentence because it begins with a dependent clause.

- *Because he organized his sources by theme, it was easier for his readers to follow.*
 - Note the comma in this sentence because it begins with a dependent clause.
- **They studied APA rules for many hours** *as they were so interesting.*
 - Note that there is no comma in this sentence because it begins with an independent clause.
- Using some complex sentences in writing allows for more sentence variety.

4. Compound-Complex Sentences

Sentence types can also be combined. A compound-complex sentence contains at least **two** independent clauses and at least **one** dependent clause.

Key: independent clause = **yellow, bold**; comma or semicolon = pink, regular font; coordinating conjunction = **green, underlined**; dependent clause = *blue, italics*

- **She completed her literature review, but she still needs to work on her methods section** *even though she finished her methods course last semester.*
- *Although he organized his sources by theme,* **he decided to arrange them chronologically, and he carefully followed the MEAL plan for organization.**
- *With pizza and soda at hand,* **they studied APA rules for many hours, and they decided that writing in APA made sense** *because it was clear, concise, and objective.*
- Using some complex-compound sentences in writing allows for more sentence variety.
- Pay close attention to **comma** usage in complex-compound sentences so that the reader is easily able to follow the intended meaning.

Time for Practice

Activity

Identify the sentence type:

- 1) I sent him an email but he did not answer me back.
- 2) Although I revised very well, I got a bad mark.
- 3) I apologized to my best friend who blamed me for not attending her wedding.
- 4) They will travel to London by next week.
- 5) Mary lost the job yet she is not angry.

References

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